EXPERIMENT – 5

Performing Various Configurations of IPTables Firewall in Kali Linux

Aim

To perform and analyze various firewall configurations using IPTables in Kali Linux to control network traffic and enhance system security.

Software Requirements

- **Host Operating System:** Windows / Linux / macOS
- **Virtualization Software:** Oracle VirtualBox
- **Guest Operating System:** Kali Linux
- **Firewall Tool:** IPTables
- **System Requirements:**
  - RAM: Minimum 4 GB (8 GB recommended)
  - Disk Space: Minimum 30 GB
  - Processor: Intel/AMD with Virtualization support

Introduction

IPTables is a powerful firewall utility in Linux used to configure rules for filtering incoming and outgoing network traffic. It operates by defining rules based on IP addresses, ports, and protocols. Configuring IPTables helps protect systems from unauthorized access, network attacks, and malicious traffic. Kali Linux provides built-in support for IPTables, making it suitable for learning firewall configurations in a controlled environment.

Procedure

Step 1: Start Kali Linux Virtual Machine

1. Open Oracle VirtualBox.
2. Start the Kali Linux virtual machine.
3. Log in using Kali credentials.

Step 2: Open Terminal and Check IPTables

1. Open **Terminal** in Kali Linux.
2. Check IPTables version:
3. iptables --version

Step 3: View Existing Firewall Rules

1. Display current IPTables rules:
2. sudo iptables -L

Step 4: Set Default Policies

1. Set default policy to drop incoming traffic:

2. sudo iptables -P INPUT DROP
3. Allow outgoing traffic:
4. sudo iptables -P OUTPUT ACCEPT

Step 5: Allow Localhost Traffic

1. Allow loopback interface traffic:
2. sudo iptables -A INPUT -i lo -j ACCEPT

Step 6: Allow SSH Access

1. Allow SSH connections on port 22:
2. sudo iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 22 -j ACCEPT

Step 7: Allow HTTP and HTTPS Traffic

1. Allow HTTP traffic:
2. sudo iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 80 -j ACCEPT
3. Allow HTTPS traffic:
4. sudo iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 443 -j ACCEPT

Step 8: Block a Specific IP Address

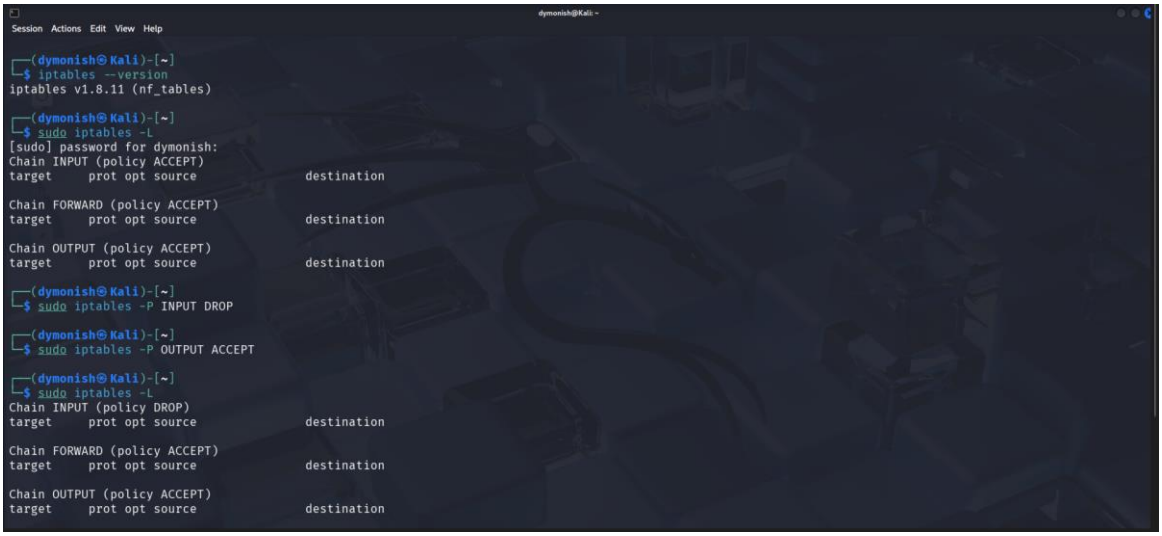
1. Block traffic from a specific IP:
2. sudo iptables -A INPUT -s 192.168.1.100 -j DROP

Step 9: Save IPTables Rules

1. Save the configured rules:
2. sudo iptables-save > firewall_rules.txt

Output

- Firewall rules are successfully applied.
- Network traffic is filtered based on configured IPTables rules.



```
┌──(dymonish㉿Kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo iptables -A INPUT -i lo -j ACCEPT

┌──(dymonish㉿Kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 22 -j ACCEPT

┌──(dymonish㉿Kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 443 -j ACCEPT

┌──(dymonish㉿Kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo iptables -A INPUT -s 192.168.1.100 -j DROP

┌──(dymonish㉿Kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo iptables -L
Chain INPUT (policy DROP)
target     prot opt source               destination
ACCEPT     all  --  anywhere             anywhere
ACCEPT     tcp  --  anywhere             anywhere             tcp dpt:ssh
ACCEPT     tcp  --  anywhere             anywhere             tcp dpt:https
DROP       all  --  192.168.1.100        anywhere

Chain FORWARD (policy ACCEPT)
target     prot opt source               destination

Chain OUTPUT (policy ACCEPT)
target     prot opt source               destination

┌──(dymonish㉿Kali)-[~]
└─$ sudo iptables-save > firewall_rules.txt
```

```
┌──(dymonish㉿Kali)-[~]
└─$ cat firewall_rules.txt
# Generated by iptables-save v1.8.11 (nf_tables) on Thu Apr 23 20:48:45 2026
*filter
:INPUT DROP [17:544]
:FORWARD ACCEPT [0:0]
:OUTPUT ACCEPT [4:344]
-A INPUT -i lo -j ACCEPT
-A INPUT -p tcp -m tcp --dport 22 -j ACCEPT
-A INPUT -p tcp -m tcp --dport 443 -j ACCEPT
-A INPUT -s 192.168.1.100/32 -j DROP
COMMIT
# Completed on Thu Apr 23 20:48:45 2026
```

Result

Various firewall configurations were successfully implemented using IPTables in Kali Linux. The experiment demonstrates how firewall rules can be used to control network traffic and improve system security.

Reference

https://www.kali.org/docs/networking/iptables/